

Travel Policy

Company: [Company Name] | Effective Date: [Insert Date] | Policy Owner: Human Resources / Finance

Purpose: This sample policy is designed for internal company use and should be reviewed and adapted to local laws, tax rules, employment requirements, and company-specific practices before adoption.

1. Scope and Objectives

This policy applies to employees, contractors, and approved guests who travel on authorized company business. Its goals are to support safe, productive travel; control costs; ensure consistent reimbursement; and define approval responsibilities.

- Business travel must have a clear business purpose and be approved before booking.
- Travelers are expected to use reasonable judgment and select practical, cost-effective options.
- Personal preferences may be accommodated when they do not create additional company cost or risk.

2. Travel Authorization

Domestic and international business travel must be approved by the employee's manager before any non-refundable booking is made. International travel may also require approval from senior management, HR, Legal, Security, or Finance depending on destination and business risk.

Required pre-trip information

- Purpose of travel, destination, dates, and expected business outcome.
- Estimated airfare, lodging, ground transportation, meals, and other material costs.
- Any visa, passport, vaccination, security, accessibility, or special accommodation needs.

3. Booking Standards

Air travel

Employees should book through the company-approved booking channel when one is available. Economy class is the standard for flights under 6 hours. Premium economy or business class requires documented business justification and approval under the company's authorization matrix.

- Book reasonably in advance whenever plans are known.
- Select the lowest logical fare that meets business timing needs, not simply the lowest possible fare.
- Reasonable seat selection, one checked bag, and standard booking fees may be reimbursable when business-related.

Hotels

Choose safe, business-appropriate lodging close to the work location. Nightly rates should be within the company's published city limits or a reasonable market rate when no limit exists. Luxury upgrades are not reimbursable unless required for business or accessibility reasons.

Ground transportation

Use public transit, rideshare, taxi, rental car, or personal vehicle based on safety, practicality, and total cost. Rental cars should generally be compact or mid-size unless passenger count, equipment, weather, or safety needs justify a larger class.

4. Meals and Incidental Expenses

Meals during approved business travel may be reimbursed using either actual reasonable costs with receipts or a company-approved per diem method. The same method should be applied consistently for a given trip where possible.

- Alcohol is not reimbursable unless specifically permitted for an approved client or business-hosting event.
- Mini-bar, in-room entertainment, personal grooming, tourism, and similar personal expenses are not reimbursable.
- Tips should be reasonable and consistent with local custom.

5. Combining Business and Personal Travel

Employees may combine personal travel with a business trip when approved in advance and when it does not interfere with business responsibilities. The employee is responsible for any incremental airfare, lodging, meals, transportation, insurance, or other costs caused by the personal portion of the trip.

Travel costs for spouses, partners, dependents, or other companions are personal unless their attendance is specifically approved for a legitimate business purpose.

6. Safety, Security, and Emergencies

Employees should follow applicable travel advisories, company security guidance, local laws, and health requirements. Employees should not be required to travel to a location where the company determines there is an unreasonable safety risk.

- Keep travel documents and company devices secure.
- Report accidents, theft, hospitalization, detention, or major travel disruption promptly to the company contact designated for travel emergencies.
- Do not transport prohibited, restricted, confidential, or regulated materials without required approvals.

7. Cancellations and Unused Travel Credits

Travelers should cancel reservations promptly when plans change. Airline credits, hotel credits, and other company-funded travel credits belong to the company and should be reused for future business travel when allowed.

8. Expense Submission

Travel expenses must be submitted through the company expense process, normally within 10 business days after returning. Receipts and business purpose documentation are required in accordance with the Expense Policy.

Policy Administration: Questions about this policy should be directed to the policy owner. [Company Name] may revise this policy at any time, subject to applicable law and required notice.